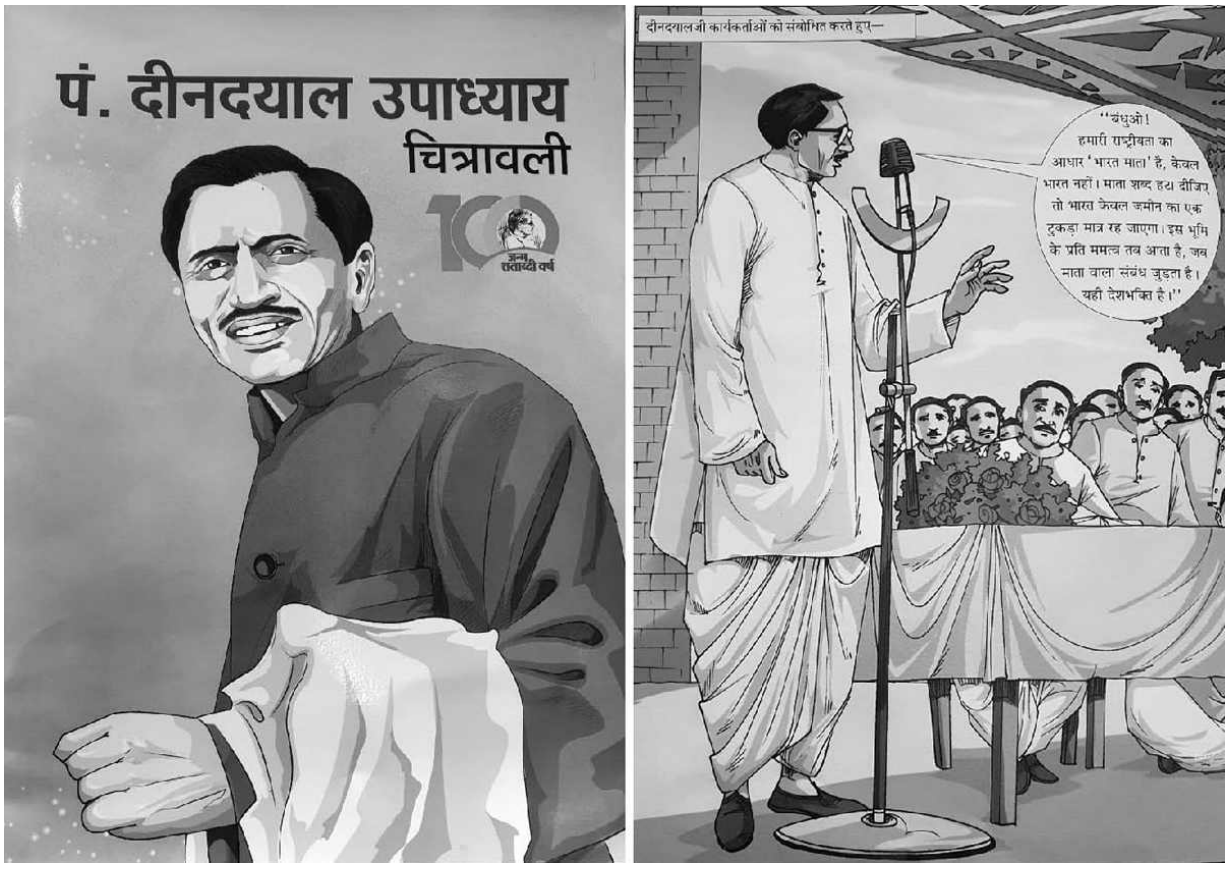
Figure 9.3: Deendayal Upadhayaya Comic at the BJP Headquarters, Delhi. He is One of Only Two Jan Sangh Leaders Whose Life Story is Enshrined in Comic Form and Promoted by the BJP



The comic depicts Deendayal Upadhyaya saying that Indian nationalism is predicated on 'Bharat Mata' (Mother India), not just India. 'Without the word "Mata", Bharat will remain only a piece of land,' he says in the comic. Upadhayaya is also the only political leader in whose name the Modi government has rechristened some Central government schemes. Images from 'Deendayal Upadhyaya Chitrawali' published by Prabhat Prakashan, Deen Dayal Shodh Sansthan, New Delhi.

The 'Rule of 75': Why Did the Jan Sangh Not Win Elections?

In 1969, a young Jan Sangh worker and lawyer in Bombay, Narandas Mehta, the youngest to contest Bombay Municipal Corporation elections in 1961, put forward a new thesis on why the party was not winning elections. Aimed at starting a major rethink among the top leadership, this provocative treatise, titled *Bharatiya Jana Sangh and the Rule of 75%*, was published by the party's Bombay branch.